

University of Zagreb
Faculty of Croatian Studies

Philosophy of Politics

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Course obligations:

- Attendance: max 3 absentias
- Written exam: Exam will be hard. Start studying immediately
- Reading
- Course materials at:
<https://github.com/skansi/polfil>

Course reading list:

- Carl Schmitt. 1932. The Concept of the Political (Foreword, chapters 1–3, 6)
- Carl Schmitt. 1922. Political Theology (Chapter 1)
- Hannah Arendt. 1951. The Origins of Totalitarianism (Part III: Totalitarianism; Chapter 11: “The Totalitarian Movement”; Chapter 13: “Ideology and Terror”)
- Adolf Hitler. 1925–1926. Mein Kampf (Vol. I, Chapter 6: “War Propaganda”; Vol. I, Chapter 11: “Nation and Race”; Vol. II, Chapter 4: “Personality and the Conception of the Folkish State”)
- Benito Mussolini and Giovanni Gentile. 1932. The Doctrine of Fascism (whole text)
- Guido Bortolotto. 1939. Dottrina del Fascismo.
- Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels. 1848. The Communist Manifesto (whole text)
- Slava Gerovitch. 2002. From Newspeak to Cyberspeak: A History of Soviet Cybernetics (Chapter 1: “Speaking Bolshevik”; Chapter 2: “Cybernetics in the Service of Communism”; Chapter 6: “InterNyet”)
- John Locke. 1689. Second Treatise of Government (Chapters 2–5, 8, 19)
- John Stuart Mill. 1859. On Liberty (Chapters 1–3)
- Friedrich A. Hayek. 1944. The Road to Serfdom (Chapters 3–6, 10)
- Isaiah Berlin. 1958. Two Concepts of Liberty (whole text)
- Robert Nozick. 1974. Anarchy, State, and Utopia (Chapters 1, 3, 7)

Course contents

- Introduction to the philosophy of politics: fundamental concepts and methodology
- The beginnings of the modern state and political ideologies
- Liberalism: historical development and fundamental principles
- Classical and contemporary liberalism: freedom, rights and democracy
- Communism: philosophical roots and Marx' critique of capitalism
- Marxism and communism in theory and practice
- Fascism: beginning, ideological roots and political theory
- Fascism in Italy: state, leader and corporativism
- Nazism: philosophical and ideological sources
- National socialism in Germany: race, state, totalitarianism
- Totalitarianism as a political and philosophical problem
- Comparative analysis of liberalism, communism, fascism and nazism
- Human rights, equality, freedom between political ideologies

Conceptual Architecture of the Course

Ideology	Central Concept	Representative Problem
Nazism	Existential politics	Who belongs to the political community, and who is the enemy?
Fascism	Ethical-organic state	What is political unity, and what is the individual's place within the state?
Communism	Historical and technical rationality	Can society and history be rationally organized toward a collective end?
Liberalism	Individual liberty and pluralism	How can individual freedom coexist with political authority and social order?
Libertarianism	Self-ownership and minimal government	What, if anything, may the state legitimately compel individuals to do?

Deeper Structural Logic of the Full Course

Tradition	Core Political Unit	Fundamental Threat	Political Solution
Nazism	Race / Volk	Racial and existential enemy	Racial unity, leadership, sovereign struggle
Fascism	Nation / state	Individualism, fragmentation, class conflict	Ethical state, hierarchy, corporative unity
Communism	Class / historical humanity	Class domination and exploitation	Revolution, abolition of class society, collective organization
Liberalism	Individual / citizen	Arbitrary power and coercion	Rights, constitutional government, pluralism
Libertarianism	Self-owning individual	Coercion, especially by the state	Strong property rights and the minimal state